



Moodle Plugins for Online Education: The BigBlueButtonBN

This is the second article in the series of articles on Moodle plugins for online education. For those readers joining in now, the earlier article was published in *OSFY* in September 2020. For the sake of continuity, we strongly advise those who have missed out the previous article to go through it.



The previous article referred to in the introduction described Interactive Content – H5P, a plugin used to include H5P content to your courses running on Moodle. H5P is a JavaScript based free and open source collaborative framework. We also discussed how to install a local copy of Moodle in your system and to add users and courses.

We assume that you have a local copy of Moodle installed in your system and that you know how to add

users and courses. Let us try to address yet another problem faced by teachers while running online courses – “How to conduct Web conferences for live discussions?”

Nowadays, it is relatively easy to record videos of your classes and upload them to YouTube so that the students can watch them at their convenience. If uploading video lectures was the only requirement of conducting online classes, teachers would soon become jobless. The most challenging aspect of conducting online

classes is making sure that the students in the class are following the lectures in the videos, from the toppers to the back-benchers. For this, a teacher has to conduct frequent reviews, tests, doubt clearing sessions, etc, most of which would be very difficult to automate – making teaching a safe profession until the arrival of true AI.

Thus, a mandatory requirement for conducting an effective online course is the availability of a good Web/video conferencing application. Of course, the world is full of such applications that we

